MANUAL QA · ESTIMATOR

Estimator QA Walkthrough

One run through the whole flow: scope a quote, send it to Zoho, walk the deal up the pipeline, raise the purchase order, start the project. Follow the steps in order — each one sets up the next.

ESTIMATOR ZOHO CRM PBS BILLING

BEFORE YOU START

- Sign in as an **admin** or **manager** — the Estimator is hidden from members and viewers.
- Use a **test client** in Zoho. Steps 4 onward write to the real CRM, and step 8 writes to real billing.
- Keep a Zoho tab open alongside — you'll be checking that both sides agree.

The run

Nine steps, roughly fifteen minutes. Pricing is always hours × `$100/h`, so every amount you see should trace back to the hours.

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01 **Create the estimate** ESTIMATOR

Estimator → **New estimate**. Give it a title and a client name.

> EXPECT It opens straight into the editor on **Line items**, with one empty starter row.

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02 **Scope the work** ESTIMATOR

Either way works — try one: **Browse catalog** to pull in rows for the platform, or **Scope & risk** → **Start guided scoping**, answer the questionnaire, then **Generate line items**.

> EXPECT The header total updates as you go. Guided scoping also gives you a **Timeline** with a launch date and a risk score.

03 Attach the client and products

ESTIMATOR ZOHO CRM

Setup tab → **Find in Zoho** on the Client field, pick a company then a contact. Then **Add from Zoho** and pick two or three products.

> EXPECT Each product gets a share of the hours, and those shares add up to *exactly* the estimate total — nothing is typed by hand.

04 Send it to Zoho

ESTIMATOR ZOHO CRM

Review tab → **Send to Zoho**. Read the preview before confirming: stage, amount, hours, how many Packages rows, and the description under each product.

> EXPECT The deal lands on `Discovery`, the proposal PDF is attached, and each Packages row carries **that product's own description from the Zoho catalogue** — not the hours note.
>
> Open the deal in Zoho and check the **Amount** matches the estimate.

05 Find it on the board

ESTIMATOR

Go back to the Estimator list. It opens on **Stages**.

> EXPECT Your estimate is a card in the `Discovery` column. Each column header shows its own total and count, and the card shows deal name, account, contact, amount and closing date.

06 Walk it up the pipeline

ESTIMATOR ZOHO CRM

Drag the card by its handle, or use the ⇄ menu on the card. Move it along: Negotiation → Proposal Sent → Verbal Yes.

> EXPECT The card moves immediately and the deal's stage in Zoho changes to match. Refresh the Zoho tab each time and confirm they agree.

07 Win the deal

ESTIMATOR · ZOHO CRM

Move the card to **Closed Won**.

> EXPECT The estimate's status flips to **Approved** on its own — winning the deal *is* the approval, so you shouldn't have to set it.
>
> **Create PO** and **Start project** both appear, on the card and in the estimate's header.

08 Raise the purchase order

ESTIMATOR · PBS BILLING

Create PO. Check the billing client, the template, and the **project start and end dates** — they come pre-filled from the estimate's own timeline. Change them if you want, then confirm.

> EXPECT A PO number like `STR000429` appears on the card and in the header, with its status beside it.
>
> Open PBS and confirm the PO exists with those project dates. **This can't be undone** — PBS has no delete.

09 Start the project

ESTIMATOR

Start project → review the schedule it proposes → **Confirm & create**.

> EXPECT A real project appears with one sprint per phase, carrying the dates you just reviewed — not recalculated behind your back.

Then try to break it

These are the guards. Each one should stop you, and say why.

Click Create PO on an estimate that already has one	→ Refused — the button is gone, and the PO number shows instead
Set the PO's end date *before* its start date	→ The confirm button disables and tells you why
Send to Zoho again after sales has moved the deal past Discovery	→ The stage stays where sales put it — the PDF and pricing still go up

Drag an estimate that has no Zoho deal	→ It won't move — it sits in `Not in Zoho` and can't be staged
Send the same unchanged estimate to Zoho twice	→ The PDF isn't attached a second time
Reject an estimate, then move its deal to Closed Won	→ It stays rejected — the stage moves, the status doesn't

Also check

Quick passes once the run above is clean.

On a phone (or a narrow window)	→ The board scrolls sideways; drag won't work, so use the ⇄ menu on each card
Switch to List view	→ Same estimates, same PO badges — nothing missing that the board showed
Edit the hours after sending, then send again	→ The dialog shows the old amount struck through, and Zoho's Amount updates
Sign in as a member or viewer	→ No Estimator in the sidebar at all

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If something looks wrong, note which step, what you expected, and what the other system showed — a screenshot of both sides side by side is worth more than a description. Anything touching Zoho or PBS is a real write, so flag it rather than retrying.